

PSA Print Packet

Proto-South American Catgirl working notes

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Source Inventory

- PSA/PSA.md
- PSA/vocab.md
- PSA/slots.md
- PSA/Conversation 1 (Gloss).md
- PSA/Conversation 1.txt
- PSA/exersizes_notes.md

Source: PSA/PSA.md

Yes, that request makes perfect sense.

What you're asking for is a single authoritative design document: not prose explanation, not argument, but a **reference bible** that freezes what PSA **is**, how it works, and why, without re-deriving it.

Below is that document.

I will not introduce new ideas.

I will not simplify away contradictions.

I will not restate the religion except where grammar requires it.

This is written in the tone of a serious descriptive grammar / conlang spec.

Proto-South American Catgirl (PSA)

Core Language Specification (“Conlang Bible”)

0. Status and Scope

- * PSA is a reconstructed proto-language, comparable to PIE:
- * predates writing
- * reconstructed from daughter languages
- * reconstruction targets the language immediately prior to a major expansion
- * Earlier speech stages existed but are not fully reconstructible and are treated as *pre-PSA*.
- * PSA already contains internal layering, erosion, and reanalysis at the moment of reconstruction.

1. Fundamental Design Principle (Highest Priority)

Priority 1: Deixis / relevance / flow of attention

PSA is not time-first, agent-first, or argument-first.

> Everything is organized around whether something is within the current attentional field, and how attention flows through the event.

This priority outranks:

- * tense
- * aspect
- * mood
- * grammatical relations
- * noun class
- * argument structure

If deixis is wrong, the clause is pragmatically invalid even if formally grammatical.

2. Noun Class System (Process Ontology)

2.1 Core Classes (Proto Stage)

PSA has three primary noun classes, encoding process state, not gender:

Class	Core meaning
-----	-----
Bearing	latent, growing, origin-state, protected
Traveling	circulating, extracted, mobile, in-process
Nursing	completed, transformed, stabilized, dangerous / sacral

These apply to:

- * people
- * animals
- * food
- * places
- * tools
- * abstractions

2.2 Marking

- * Traveling is unmarked in PSA.
- * Bearing marked by article te.
- * Nursing marked by article so.
- * Articles are:
 - * free or clitic in PSA
 - * later fuse as prefixes/suffixes in daughters

2.3 Diachronic Secondary Classes

Derived via morphology + noun class:

- * diminutive + bearing → tools, children, inanimates
- * plural + traveling → swarms, weather, rivers, forces
- * augmentative + nursing → sacred/dangerous beings, mountains, old trees
- * augmentative + bearing → land, origins, “the people”

Not all daughter languages retain these.

3. Deixis and Individuation (*si*)

3.1 Nature of *si*

- * *si* is not a definite article
- * It means:
 - > “this instance that is currently relevant / individuated”
- * Functions:
 - * individuation of mass nouns
 - * topical anchoring
 - * override of default flow assumptions

Examples:

- * *kita* → fish as commodity / circulation
- * *si kita* → this piece/batch of fish
- * *zo si kita* → this specific completed/dangerous batch

3.2 Pronouns

- * Pronouns are definite by default
- * Stacked forms (*desi, zosi*) behave as gendered demonstratives
- * Pronoun systems later erode heavily.

4. Clause-Level Deixis (True Core System)

4.1 Historical Origin

- * Descends from an abandoned possessive / relational clitic
- * Originally meant:
 - > “within my sphere / attached to me / under my responsibility”
- * Possession collapsed as a semantic category.
- * Morphology survived and generalized into attention / relevance marking.

4.2 Where Deixis Lives

Deixis is encoded in three places:

1. Clause role marker (mandatory)
2. Verb fusion / light verbs
3. Relational adpositions

NP-level *si* is only a residual shard of this system.

5. Adpositions as Deictic Paradigms

5.1 General System

- * All pre/postpositions have 2-4 surface forms
- * These forms map onto five abstract deictic levels:

1. Very near speaker (strongly speaker-anchored)
2. Near addressee
3. Shared / discourse-near ("us")
4. Default distance
5. Further than normal / backgrounded

Not all adpositions lexicalize all five.

5.2 Position Relative to Verb

- * Pre-verbal adpositions = postpositions (sources, preconditions)
- * Post-verbal adpositions = prepositions (goals, results)

5.3 Benefactive Example

Benefactive ("for / to") paradigm:

- * Speaker-proximal form:
 - * means *for me*
 - * does not take a noun
 - * Addressee-proximal form:
 - * can mean *for you* alone
 - * Shared / neutral form:
 - * default "for"
 - * Distal form:
 - * institutions, future recipients, abstractions
- Benefactive naturally drifts into telic meaning.

5.4 Instrumental Example

Instrumental has two forms:

- * "this" instrumental

- * only if instrument is more bound to speaker than addressee/topic/context
 - * “that” instrumental
 - * otherwise
- Not distance-based; sphere-of-control-based.

6. Verb System Overview

6.1 No Agreement

- * Verbs never agree with:
- * noun class
- * person
- * gender
- * All relational meaning is elsewhere.

6.2 Dual TAM Systems (Both Real)

PSA has two coexisting TAM systems.

A. Older Morphological TAM (Still Productive)

- * tense
 - * aspect
 - * mood
 - * conjunctive / dependency marking
 - * evidential overlays
- Irregular, prestige-coded, never fully dies.

B. Newer TAM via Verb + Adposition + Deixis

- * event-type verbs (“occur”, “move”, “exhaust”, etc.)
- * relational adpositions
- * deictic paradigms
- * attentional closure vs openness

This system also encodes TAM — independently.

6.3 Result: Combinatorial Explosion

Because the two systems are:

- * orthogonal
- * overlapping
- * historically accreted

They multiply into ~200 socially recognized clause types, often called “tenses” by speakers.

Speakers:

- * agree on distinctions
- * rank them pragmatically

- * cannot paraphrase them cleanly

7. Core Syntax: Event-Subject Construction

7.1 Structure

- * Verbal noun occupies subject position
- * No argument promotion occurs
- * Agent, patient, instrument are obliques

This is not a passive.

7.2 Correct Classification

> Event-subject / event-headed construction with agent demotion

No object → subject promotion.

7.3 Example (Canonical)

> painting sbj-that burnt-up by-you with-that brush for-me

> “You used your brush to completely finish painting that for me.”

- * Completion comes from burn-up
- * Not from the construction itself
- * Swap verb+adposition → different TAM

8. Subjecthood

- * PSA lacks a stable grammatical subject
- * In newer system:
 - * events outrank agents
 - * Agents may be:
 - * omitted
 - * backgrounded
 - * highlighted
 - * Responsibility ≠ syntactic prominence

9. Lexical Instability

- * Certain semantic domains resist stable roots
- * “Child” is unreconstructible:
 - * replaced by metaphors (sling, burden, jewelry)
- * Driven by:
 - * noun class semantics
 - * derivational competition
 - * attentional framing

10. Phonology

10.1 Vowels

Targets (monophthongs):

* /a i u ɪ ə/

Nasal (phonemic, restricted):

* /ã ĩ ũ ɪ̃ ə̃/

Length (unstable, stressed only):

* /a: u:/

Most stressed syllables are vowel trajectories (VV, Vj, Vw, Vr).

10.2 Consonants (Underlying ~14)

* /p t k ts s h m n l r j w ʔ/

* No phonemic voicing

* Heavy allophony

10.3 Allophony

* Palatalization before /i ɪ j/

* Intervocalic weakening (taps, glottals)

* Coda /N/ = nasal archiphoneme (Japanese-like)

* No geminates

10.4 Glottal Stop

* /ʔ/ is not a coda

* Marks prosodic word boundaries

* Appears word-initially before:

* vowels

* liquids

* sibilants

* Dropped in compounds / lexicalized phrases

10.5 Phonotactics

* Preferred syllables: (ʔ)CV, (ʔ)CVC

* No clusters

* Complexity in nuclei, not edges

Register effects:

* Formal: lexeme-faithful endings

* Casual:

* nouns open (CV)

* verbs closed (CVC with /N/)

11. Diachronic Tendencies

- * Articles fuse
- * Pronouns erode
- * Length → diphthongs/liquids
- * New TAM expands
- * Old TAM fossilizes but survives
- * Daughter languages diverge sharply

12. One-Sentence Core Definition

> Proto-South American Catgirl is a relevance-first, event-headed language with a process-based noun class system, dual overlapping TAM architectures, and a deictic attentional grammar that replaces agreement and dominates clause structure.

If you want, I can next:

- * condense this into a 1-page quick reference
- * generate a diagram of clause structure
- * or sketch how one daughter language collapses this system

But this document is now stable enough to build **from** rather than **argue about**.

PPSA Root Lexicon (Working Canon)

This document collects the current canon roots and key derivational class markers defined for Proto-PSA (PPSA), plus selected high-priority derived compounds, kinship terms, and core relational constructions.

Noun-Class / Life-Stage Markers

- * te- = Bearing class (early / fertile / initiating / trickster / smallish)
- * Ø (unmarked) = Traveling class (moving / ambitious / active default)
- * so- = Nursing class (completed / containing / nurturing / respected / commanding)

Historical note: The prefix te- did not originally exist as an independent morpheme. It was later reanalyzed from the word tesint (see below). Only after this reanalysis did *te-* become a productive bearing-class marker.

Class marking is usually lexicalized, but in some kinship terms it may remain semantically productive (e.g., *te-sikimani* vs *sikimani* vs *so-sikimani*).

Core Roots (Canon)

Terrain & Materials

- * hu = water (default / flowing)
- * astro = earth / ground / floor / forest (general terrain)
- * iman = breast
- * tsan = textile / rope / woven material
- * pak = big-toe claw / kicking claw (historically also stake/post)
- * se = wood / branch (material head in compounds)

Animals & Body Substances

- * ram = domestic pig (pig-analog; aquatic eutransdontid)
- * ?has = fish (generic)
- * ?rom = fat / grease
- * sorom = rancid / spoiled / gone bad (especially of food, grease, or preserved matter)
- * ?ank = bone
- * upon = (semi-)edible plant matter (leaf / tuber / nut / grain; not wood)
- * pum = hand claw (deep semantic category; distinct from pak 'foot claw')

Core Verbs / Light Verbs

- * mus = give
- * sik = take
- * kemi = use / employ
- * kemitsotan = speak / use breath / speak aloud
- * luma = general motion verb (go / come / carry / throw / enter / leave; meaning determined by relational marking)
- * lante = settle / lower oneself
- * ?en = rise / stand
- * rokunk = hunt
- * utun = home (dwelling / place of return; distinct from built structure)
- * ronst = cook / apply fire (base for boil / roast / smoke / salt compounds)
- * u:kani = push against / clutch (later evolves into PSA event-frame verb *miw wukani*)

Social / Relational Roots

* tesint = belly → later “person who was pregnant (with me).”

This form is the historical source of the te- prefix. Only later was *tesint* reanalyzed folk-etymologically as *te-sint*, allowing *te-* to spread as a productive bearing marker.

The reduced element sint is sometimes used poetically to mean “catgirl,” but never becomes the default term.

* mank = obligation / debt (final *nk* realized [ŋk] → [ŋ]; emphatic reduplicated form *mankank* /mangay/ bleached into basic lexical form)

Core Relational Markers (PPSA)

* miw = upward / above / upright / superior orientation (structurally central adposition)

* pai = interior / between / within relation

* kun = toward / to

* ʔrap = away from / from

* kent = by holding / carried-by

* kept = by propelling / thrown-by

(Note: In motion constructions, the carried/thrown entity receives topic marking.)

Selected Derived Lexemes (PPSA Stage)

Water System

* river = *hu-hu* → huhu

* pond / containing water = *so-hu* → sohu

Boundaries / Enclosures

* boundary / bank = *tsan-pak* → tsanpak

* fence / enclosure (wood as head; containing boundary)

= *se-so-tsanpak* → sesotsanpak

Landforms

* hill = *iman-astro* → imanastro (“earth-breast,” breast as head)

* open ground / meadow = *astro-so-hu* → astrosohu (earth-pond logic)

* mud = *so-hu-ram* → sohuram (pond-pig logic)

* stone = *astro-astro* → astrostro

Dwelling & Fire

* house (built structure) = *so-se-so-se* → sosesose (archetypal “finished wood,” reduced form)

* hearth = *so-se-ronst* → soseronst (finished wood-fire place)

* mayor / village head / lord = *so-se-so-se-tsene* → sosesosetsene (“house-name,” the house by which the settlement is known; later broadens toward “ruler”)

Fishing & Hunting Toolkit

* hook for fish = *pum-ʔhas* → pumahas

* trap / snare = *tsan-(u)-rokunk* → tsanurokunk

* butcher / cut meat = *rokunk-utun* → rokunkutun

Feeding & Exchange

* feed (animals) = *mus-upon* → musupon

* trade = *mus-sik* → musik (give-take)

* crush / grind = *astro-stro-kimi* → astrostrokimi (“stone-use,” i.e. reduce by working against stone)

Kinship Terms

* woman who bore me = tesint (historically unanalyzable at earliest stage; only later reinterpreted as *te-sint*)

* woman who nursed me = *so-kemi-iman* → sokemiman (nursing breast-user)

* child (actual child stage) = *te-kemi-iman-i* → tekemimani (bearing breast-user-DIM)

* younger / same-age sibling (traveling stage default) = *sik-iman-i* → sikimani (breast-taker-DIM)

* may appear as te-sikimani (young child stage)

* may appear as so-sikimani (elder reference)

* older sibling = *mus-iman* → musiman (breast-giver)

* guest = *kemi-huhu* → kemihuhu (river-user)

Motion & Posture Constructions

* go / come toward = *luma kun*

* go / leave from = *luma ʔrap*

* carry (by holding) = *luma kent*

* throw (by propelling) = *luma kept*

* settle / sit / calm = *lante pai*

* sit upright = *lante miw*

* stand up = *ʔen miw*

Cooking

* boil = *ronst-hu* → ronstuhu

* roast / bake (dry cook; fire-fire) = *ronst-ronst* → ronstonst

* salt = *ronst-astro-so-huhu* → ronstastrosohuhu

* smoke = *ronst-astro-ronst* → ronstastroront

Body & Vitality

* blood = ro

* breath = tsotan

* hand = nen

* foot = amant

* hunger = nepant

* sleep = sun

Weather & Time

* rain = *miw-hu* → miwhu (water from above)

* dry / drought = hanst

* wind = etna

* cold (noun) = *etna-hu* → etnahu (wet-wind)

* cold (adjectival construction) = *[noun] etnahu kent iru* (cold-carrying; with free relativizer iru)

* dawn = atup

* night = hetnos

Speech, Law & the Unseen

- * name / word = tsene
- * oath = *tsene-mank* → tsenemank (name of debt)
- * taboo / prohibition / mistake = *tsan-ro* → tsanro (blood-rope)
- * forbidden = *pai tsanro*
- * ancestor = lexicalized compound from “nursing breast-user (burned) within” → provisional form sokemimanpai (historically cremation-based; exact reduction to be determined)
- * spirit = *uuki miw iru* (they who lurk above; iru present in PPSA as free relativizing element, not yet fused)
- * Nicaragua = sohumanki (“the promised river”; lexicalized place-name)

Structural Notes

- * iru exists in PPSA as an independent relativizing / clause-linking element; fusion and suffixal behavior develop later in PSA.
- * iiru exists in PPSA is just iru with emphasis but early in the transition to PSA it becomes lexicalized as a interrogative pronoun, before fusing onto the preposition along with the other “persons/distances”.
- * Compounding rule: head-first, with a strong tendency for material heads (e.g., *se-...*).
- * Life-stage markers (*te- / Ø / so-*) are derivational noun-class prefixes tied to cultural life stages.
- * In some kinship terms, class marking may remain semantically productive rather than strictly lexicalized.
- * Relational meaning is largely carried by adpositions rather than verb roots.
- * PPSA compounds are morphologically transparent; opacity emerges later in PSA through sound change.

Source: PSA/slots.md

You're asking for semantic slots, not words — a core lexeme inventory for PPSA at the stage just before perfected pig + fish farming. So:

- * settled or semi-settled
- * fishing is important
- * pigs exist but breeding intensification is just emerging
- * compound nouns common
- * SVO grammar
- * no heavy state bureaucracy yet
- * rich distal marking system

So we want a lexicon that reflects:

- * subsistence
- * kin + household
- * movement + place
- * material culture
- * early ritual
- * social obligations
- * weather + water
- * proto-agricultural cycles

Not abstract philosophy yet.

Here's a curated list of ~60 root meaning slots appropriate to that cultural stage.

You can decide which are simple roots vs compounds later.

100 Environment & Landscape (10)

1. water (generic)
2. river / flowing water
3. still water / pond
4. hill / rise
5. forest / wooded land
6. open ground / clearing
7. mud / wet earth
8. stone / rock
9. fire (controlled)

2000 Animals & Subsistence (12)

- 11. pig (wild boar ancestor stage)
- 12. fish (generic)
- 13. net (fishing net)
- 14. hook / line
- 15. trap / snare
- 16. hunt (verb)
- 17. butcher / cut meat
- 18. fat / grease
- 19. bone
- 20. herd / group of animals
- 21. feed (animals)
- 22. salt / smoke (preserve food)

3000 Early Cultivation & Food Processing (8)

23. seed

24. plant / grow (verb)

25. dig (earth)

26. fence / enclosure

27. store / keep food

28. grind / crush

29. cook (boil/roast)

30. rot / spoil

4000 Household & Social Units (10)

- 31. house / shelter
- 32. hearth
- 33. mother
- 34. father
- 35. child
- 36. sibling
- 37. clan / household unit
- 38. guest / outsider
- 39. exchange / give
- 40. debt / obligation

5000 Motion & Position (8)

- 41. go
- 42. come
- 43. carry
- 44. throw
- 45. enter
- 46. leave
- 47. sit / settle
- 48. stand / rise

6000 Body & Vitality (6)

49. blood

50. breath

51. hand

52. foot

53. belly / hunger

54. sleep

700 Weather & Cycles (6)

55. rain

56. dry / drought

57. wind

58. cold

59. dawn

60. night

8000 Early Ritual / Proto-Abstract (Optional but fitting)

- 61. name
- 62. promise / oath
- 63. taboo / forbidden
- 64. ancestor
- 65. spirit / unseen force

Why this list fits “just before perfected pig & fish farming”

- * Nets, traps, enclosures, storing, and smoking exist.
- * But no advanced irrigation, no markets, no coinage.
- * Kinship and obligation matter more than formal state structure.
- * Weather and land cycles are crucial.
- * Ritual is present but still concrete.

If you want, next step we can:

- * Categorize these into likely monosyllabic vs disyllabic PPSA roots
- * Or assign which ones are more likely to be compound nouns
- * Or design semantic fields that preferentially end in -n (to feed your nasal-grade system)

Which direction do you want to go?

Night is bad.

Don't leave it until too late.

?? = $\frac{1}{x^2} = x^{-2} \Rightarrow \frac{d}{dx} x^{-2} = -2x^{-3} = -\frac{2}{x^3}$

MOTHER:

* 1 = 7 = = 7 7 Z > > 7 I Z 7 7 1 > 7 Z 1 = Z
Z + 7

DAUGHTER:

$$\begin{array}{cc} \begin{array}{c} \nearrow \\ \times \end{array} & \begin{array}{c} \equiv \\ \equiv \\ \equiv \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \nearrow \\ \times \end{array} \\ \begin{array}{c} \nearrow \\ \times \end{array} & \begin{array}{c} \equiv \\ \equiv \\ \equiv \end{array} \end{array}$$

MOTHER:

7==77 Z>> ^ > **77 I= 77 7>>7+777= 77

DAUGHTER:

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30 31 32 33 34 35 36 37 38 39 40 41 42 43 44 45 46 47 48 49 50 51 52 53 54 55 56 57 58 59 60 61 62 63 64 65 66 67 68 69 70 71 72 73 74 75 76 77 78 79 80 81 82 83 84 85 86 87 88 89 90 91 92 93 94 95 96 97 98 99 100 101 102 103 104 105 106 107 108 109 110 111 112 113 114 115 116 117 118 119 120 121 122 123 124 125 126 127 128 129 130 131 132 133 134 135 136 137 138 139 140 141 142 143 144 145 146 147 148 149 150 151 152 153 154 155 156 157 158 159 160 161 162 163 164 165 166 167 168 169 170 171 172 173 174 175 176 177 178 179 180 181 182 183 184 185 186 187 188 189 190 191 192 193 194 195 196 197 198 199 200 201 202 203 204 205 206 207 208 209 210 211 212 213 214 215 216 217 218 219 220 221 222 223 224 225 226 227 228 229 230 231 232 233 234 235 236 237 238 239 240 241 242 243 244 245 246 247 248 249 250 251 252 253 254 255 256 257 258 259 260 261 262 263 264 265 266 267 268 269 270 271 272 273 274 275 276 277 278 279 280 281 282 283 284 285 286 287 288 289 290 291 292 293 294 295 296 297 298 299 300 301 302 303 304 305 306 307 308 309 310 311 312 313 314 315 316 317 318 319 320 321 322 323 324 325 326 327 328 329 330 331 332 333 334 335 336 337 338 339 340 341 342 343 344 345 346 347 348 349 350 351 352 353 354 355 356 357 358 359 360 361 362 363 364 365 366 367 368 369 370 371 372 373 374 375 376 377 378 379 380 381 382 383 384 385 386 387 388 389 390 391 392 393 394 395 396 397 398 399 400 401 402 403 404 405 406 407 408 409 410 411 412 413 414 415 416 417 418 419 420 421 422 423 424 425 426 427 428 429 430 431 432 433 434 435 436 437 438 439 440 441 442 443 444 445 446 447 448 449 450 451 452 453 454 455 456 457 458 459 460 461 462 463 464 465 466 467 468 469 470 471 472 473 474 475 476 477 478 479 480 481 482 483 484 485 486 487 488 489 490 491 492 493 494 495 496 497 498 499 500 501 502 503 504 505 506 507 508 509 510 511 512 513 514 515 516 517 518 519 520 521 522 523 524 525 526 527 528 529 530 531 532 533 534 535 536 537 538 539 540 541 542 543 544 545 546 547 548 549 550 551 552 553 554 555 556 557 558 559 560 561 562 563 564 565 566 567 568 569 570 571 572 573 574 575 576 577 578 579 580 581 582 583 584 585 586 587 588 589 590 591 592 593 594 595 596 597 598 599 600 601 602 603 604 605 606 607 608 609 610 611 612 613 614 615 616 617 618 619 620 621 622 623 624 625 626 627 628 629 630 631 632 633 634 635 636 637 638 639 640 641 642 643 644 645 646 647 648 649 650 651 652 653 654 655 656 657 658 659 660 661 662 663 664 665 666 667 668 669 670 671 672 673 674 675 676 677 678 679 680 681 682 683 684 685 686 687 688 689 690 691 692 693 694 695 696 697 698 699 700 701 702 703 704 705 706 707 708 709 710 711 712 713 714 715 716 717 718 719 720 721 722 723 724 725 726 727 728 729 730 731 732 733 734 735 736 737 738 739 740 741 742 743 744 745 746 747 748 749 750 751 752 753 754 755 756 757 758 759 760 761 762 763 764 765 766 767 768 769 770 771 772 773 774 775 776 777 778 779 780 781 782 783 784 785 786 787 788 789 790 791 792 793 794 795 796 797 798 799 800 801 802 803 804 805 806 807 808 809 810 811 812 813 814 815 816 817 818 819 820 821 822 823 824 825 826 827 828 829 830 831 832 833 834 835 836 837 838 839 840 841 842 843 844 845 846 847 848 849 850 851 852 853 854 855 856 857 858 859 860 861 862 863 864 865 866 867 868 869 870 871 872 873 874 875 876 877 878 879 880 881 882 883 884 885 886 887 888 889 890 891 892 893 894 895 896 897 898 899 900 901 902 903 904 905 906 907 908 909 910 911 912 913 914 915 916 917 918 919 920 921 922 923 924 925 926 927 928 929 930 931 932 933 934 935 936 937 938 939 940 941 942 943 944 945 946 947 948 949 950 951 952 953 954 955 956 957 958 959 960 961 962 963 964 965 966 967 968 969 970 971 972 973 974 975 976 977 978 979 980 981 982 983 984 985 986 987 988 989 990 991 992 993 994 995 996 997 998 999 1000 1001 1002 1003 1004 1005 1006 1007 1008 1009 1010 1011 1012 1013 1014 1015 1016 1017 1018 1019 1020 1021 1022 1023 1024 1025 1026 1027 1028 1029 1030 1031 1032 1033 1034 1035 1036 1037 1038 1039 104

MOTHER:

[illegible]

DAUGHTER:

$$1 \equiv 2 \pmod{3} \quad 2 \equiv 1 \pmod{3}$$

MOTHER:

$\tau \tau$
 $\frac{1}{I} \times$
 $\tau \tau$

Conversation 1

MOTHER:

hu petĩ kɪtɪts lɐmɐsar sɐtɔ pɔnũ sar petyir

DAUGHTER:

me tĩ sar petĩ tsār

MOTHER:

kɪtɪts lɐmɐ myu ʔitɔnɔ pat tɔs pɔnũ sũ petĩnitit tsār

DAUGHTER:

stosterrɪkim petĩ metĩ ɔnũk. metĩ ʔitɔnɔ petĩ kitswisar sɔtɔ lɐmɐ

MOTHER:

ʔĩ pitit yais kɔkaitu pitit sar tsār, tup petĩnitit serom

DAUGHTER:

petĩnitit metĩ sar kɔtɔ

MOTHER:

tɔs pai tsār

Linguistic Periodization

* PPSA / Orinoco Horizon (~4000-3000 BID):

Earlier related speech varieties before full homogenization. Important for design reconstruction, but not recoverable in-universe as a single stable language.

* PSA Proper (~2300-1800? BID):

The reconstructible common ancestor. This corresponds to broad regional linguistic and material-cultural commonality after the emergence of cities, before major daughter-language divergence.

* Post-PSA / Early Daughter Continuum (~1900-400 BID):

PSA-descended varieties spread and differentiate, including the ancestors of Sahumāk, A recognisable group called the Golden family descends from speakers living in OTL Costa Rica and Panama.

* Tar-Bird Horizon / Pre-Classical Sahumank (~400 BID-50 AID):

An archaeologically distinct 'horizon' starts around OTL San Juan river and OTL lake Nicuagua, showing farming of animal feed, and aquaculture, as well as the euphemistic "Tar-Birds", bird shaped impressions, carvings, and mummifications covered or composed of asphalt like tar, or black water proof shalacs. They are clearly similar to the earlier and contemporaneous material culture in OTL Costa Rica but are also very distinct.

Pre-Classical Sahumank exists as a speech community mostly isolated from other PSA descended languages. Textile writing system undergoes heavy simplification and phonologization eventually becoming a hemi-syllabary, these are depicted in durable media, but the writing form does not transfer well, being effectively a form of pseudo-graphia just depicting the form of the weaving, rather than being readable. There does seem to have been somewhat extensive experimentation with trying to make readable depictions of textile writing, but the attempts to mirror texture or three dimensional shape don't work well.

* Classical Sahumāk (~0-370 AID):

Attested written daughter language. Sudden durable inscriptions likely reflect transfer from older textile literacy, not invention of writing. The major innovation is the creation of straight line glyphs replacing patterns of which thread is woven above the 'weft', and how the weft is locked to the next row. Notes on both systems are in the Sahumank folder.

Misc. Notes for reorganization later.

PSA is an externally a priori language: it is not descended from or modeled on any real-world language family. Internally, however, it is treated as a reconstructed proto-language, comparable in cultural importance to Proto-Indo-European before the Age of Sail. It is the reconstructed ancestor of several languages spoken by the Catgirls of southern Middle America and northern South America. One known daughter language, Sahumank, will serve as an internal reference point for future reconstruction and family design.

Tvahn (an modern era name for the world) is wetter and cooler than Earth, with smaller deserts and larger forests. Tvahn is technically an alternate history, but more accurately alternate natural history. The main divergence occurs in the Mesozoic, after monotremes and therian mammals split. The dominant later mammalian branch evolved a staged reproductive system tying nursing, fertility, and male gamete production together, meaning reproduction cannot occur through a lone mother. This biology strongly shapes PSA's grammar, especially its process-based noun classes: Bearing, Traveling, and Nursing.

PSA speakers live in a riverine, forested region (The Orinoco valley at first then expanding west and north) where fishing, wetland animals, early pig-analog management, and household obligation are central. The language is reconstructed for the period just before a major expansion, likely connected to improved fish and pig farming, river travel, and growing inter-household ritual networks.

Two closely related sapient species share this world. Their relationship resembles a caste-like social arrangement, though it is less directly exploitative than comparable human systems because their evolved social rewards encourage interspecies cooperation more than direct competition. The smaller A. minorus often appears uncomfortably subservient to American human observers, and this relationship may influence PSA's deixis, address systems, obligation vocabulary, and social registers. Communities have been mixed since predating A. minor's development of speech, so usually any variation between species is closer to class based "dialects" or "private languages" among an extended family than true separate languages, and even that level of difference is almost always a skew in 'register' use rather than a difference in capabilities. That is in a given region the linguistic variation is largely between locations and households, not split into A. minor and M. major communities.

'Households' are large by human standards, 5 is the minimum realistic size, and >10 is more normal. They don't really pair bond the way we do, instead a given group is generally fairly promiscuous with sex being more about social status and comfort than either a pair bond or harem like system. This varies less than it does in humans, but this should still be considered just the standard baseline, the way small extended families is the human default.

PSA speakers are short-muzzled mammals with carnivore-descended dentition, but their lips, tongue, and jaw control support broadly humanlike articulation. Their front teeth and lips permit bilabials and rounded vowels, while their non-primate tooth pattern makes labiodentals and dental fricatives rare or absent. PSA therefore favors bilabials, alveolar/postalveolar stops and affricates, velars, nasals, liquids, glides, /s h/, and glottal contrasts rather than fine dental or labiodental contrasts.

phonotactic notes from examining the PPSA_to_PSA.lsc file

PSA strongly prefers open or simple closed syllables, with no ordinary consonant clusters. The normal surface syllable shapes are V, CV, VC, and CVC, though V and VC mostly occur word-initially or through erosion. The affricate /ts/ behaves as a single consonant, not a cluster.

Complexity is concentrated in the nucleus rather than the margins. High vowels become glides beside other vowels, producing surface /j w/ and vowel-glide sequences. Older long vowels and vowel sequences often become diphthongs or glide-vowel transitions.

Final nasals are unstable. Earlier /n/ nasalizes the preceding vowel and is then lost word-finally or before consonants, producing nasal vowels /ã ĩ ũ/. Coda consonants survive best as oral stops, /s/, /m/, /k/, /t/, and fossilized remnants of older nasal clusters.

The glottal stop /ʔ/ marks prosodic word boundaries and vowel-initial words. It is not a normal coda and is deleted or suppressed near consonants.

